

# are ppl morally wrong for using ai due to its environmental dangers , or is that the companies who own it

Posted by u/Shadieux • 0 points • 12 comments

so each time when i ask it something do i cause a huge amount of damage to the world

## Comments

u/MalusZona • 1 points • 2025-07-24 18:07 UTC

\~50 private planes flew to venice for bezose's wedding, i dont care about my personal carbon footprint

u/glopthrowawayaccount • 1 points • 2025-07-24 14:09 UTC

People should reduce use.

Companies are forcing it everywhere and constantly pushing people to use it while making regular services worse.

u/KronusIV • 1 points • 2025-07-24 13:47 UTC

All the resources get used training up the AI. You asking a question isn't doing anything much in particular.

u/DiogenesKuon • 2 points • 2025-07-24 13:36 UTC

People bear the ethical consequences of their actions, but the impact at the individual level is tiny. A ChatGPT query uses as much power as running a lightbulb for 30 seconds. Sure you shouldn't just waste power by leaving lights on while you are gone, but we don't think twice about using a light for a purpose. The environmental impact of AI only becomes noticeably bad at very larger scales, and will be a concern if we try to put AI in everything for every purpose, which is more an ethical concern for the corporations doing it.

u/Training-Ninja-1210 • 0 points • 2025-07-24 13:30 UTC

None are, as we don't know what we can achieve with it, meaning we don't know the return on investment that we have. So, we don't know, we can only know in the future.

u/Maestro\_Primus • 1 points • 2025-07-24 13:29 UTC

No, you do not do a huge amount of damage to the world whenever you ask AI a question. It is the aggregate of everyone asking lots of questions that causes the damage and your portion of that is miniscule compared to that of larger companies and the total issue.

It is very similar to driving a car. Your car produces very small amounts of pollution, but there are a lot

of other people also driving cars and it adds up. That said, cars will never compare to the emissions of private planes and factories, but people will happily focus on you and your tiny contribution.

Another thing to remember is that this is the infant stage of AI. It is still being developed, refined, tested, and redeveloped. All systems and technologies are less efficient and more damaging in their early days before people can refine them and make them both less wasteful and more effective to offset the waste.

**u/glopthrowawayaccount** • 1 points • 2025-07-24 14:10 UTC

I can't drive tens of thousands of cars a day.

**u/Maestro\_Primus** • 1 points • 2025-07-24 15:41 UTC

That's exactly my point. Your potential contribution is meaning less beside societal contributions and the contributions of either companies or the rich who have to have their private planes. That's what makes me laugh every time someone like Taylor Swift talks about the environment while hopping from place to place in her private jet.

**u/glopthrowawayaccount** • 1 points • 2025-07-24 15:48 UTC

I can make tens of thousands of AI prompts a day. Our entire use of the internet is producing AI uses at all times. Every time we post on any major site, it is being run through AI. Every photo uploaded to Facebook or Instagram, every text post on Twitter, every meme shared of Facebook that is automatically scanned and given question options under, every search. That is passive. Deliberate use of AI does all of that several times.

The issue is that the companies are forcing it into our regular use of anything online and often offline. Every retail purchase, every credit card swipe, every walk past a public camera, every connection to a public wifi.

**u/Alketry** • 3 points • 2025-07-24 13:27 UTC

Both parties are to blame. Although, obviously companies have a higher level of responsibility.

**u/ForScale** • 1 points • 2025-07-24 13:23 UTC

Neither are morally wrong.

No, your single query is not doing a huge amount of damage. You driving to the store is worse.

**u/glopthrowawayaccount** • 1 points • 2025-07-24 14:09 UTC

I need things from the store.